

Nabi Saulih ﷺ

The People of Thamood

The people of Thamood were those people who together with Nabi Hood were saved from the destruction that descended upon the people of Aad ﷺ. Their offspring became known as the 'Aad the second' and also as the Thamood of Iram.

The Habitat of Thamood

The place where Thamood settled was the land of 'Hijr' which lies between Hijaz and Syria in the valley of Qura.

The ruins of the buildings of Thamood are present there till this day. A special feature of their buildings was that their houses were hewn out of the mountains from which we can deduce that the people of Thamood were especially gifted in the art of building and architecture.

The Era of Thamood

No clear verdict can be given for the era of Thamood with any amount of certainty but what can be said is that their era was before the time of Sayeduna Ibraheem ﷺ.

The Religion of Thamood

Like their predecessors the people of Thamood too were idol worshippers. Apart from the one Allah, they also worshipped numerous false gods. For this reason one from among themselves were chosen in the form of Nabi Saulih ﷺ for advising them and guiding them on the right path as Allah's Messenger ﷺ. His task was to inform them that the whole universe is witness to the fact that Allah is but One. He reminded them of all Allah's favours upon them and preached to them that none but He is worthy of worship.

The Significance of 'Qur'ānic Stories

It is the general *Sunnat* of the Qur'ān that for the sake of the guidance of mankind it tells the stories of previous nations and their religious guides as a form of advise and admonition for the present, so that it may become known to men that those who rejected the call of the Prophets and Jeered and scoffed at them, then Allah perhaps on the demand of the Prophet and sometimes of His Own will brought such signs are generally called '*Moujizah*'. But if after such sign had appeared the people did not stop their rejection of the Prophet and continued with their enmity and hatred of him, then the punishment of Allah descended and destroyed them. These events would then remain a lesson and a warning for coming generations.

The she-camel of Allah

Nabi Saulih ﷺ continues to preach to his people and advise them but his preaching had no effect upon them. In fact their enmity continues to increase even more and their opposition to truth became stronger. They just would not leave aside their idol-worship. Only a small group of them accepted

the call and believed. The leaders of the people and the rich ones from among them remained on idol worship. Instead of expressing gratitude for all the favours of Allah, they tended to be extremely ungrateful. They used to play the fool with Nabi Saulih ﷺ and used to say:

"O Saulih If indeed we were worshippers of false hood and rejectors of Allah's true Religion and if indeed the system on which we are was not loved by Him, then today we would not be possessors of such abundance of wealth, fertile green orchards and gardens and other bounties. Look at your own self and the poor condition of your followers and their want and then decide who is Allah's favourite, we or you?"

Nabi Saulih ﷺ used to reply:

"Do not boast of your worldly wealth and comforts and do not jeer or scoff at Allah's true Messenger ﷺ. For if your arrogance and enmity is to continue then within a twinkling of an eye all that can be made to disappear. Then you will not remain and neither will your worldly possessions. All these are Allah's favours and for as long as the acquirer thereof is prepared to express gratitude and be submissive to Him. And indeed these things can be a curse and a punishment if they are held with pride and arrogant boasting. It is wrong to believe that the possession of worldly riches is necessarily a sign of Allah's pleasure and delight."

The people of Thamood found it hard to believe that one from among themselves can become Allah's Messenger ﷺ and that he should dictate to them the commands of Allah. Greatly surprised they exclaimed:

What, has the Message been sent to him (of all persons) among us. (38:8)

In other words, if Allah had to send down His Message, we would have been more suitable to receive it and not Saulih. Sometimes they used to address the poor members of his community:

"Are you certain that for sure Saulih is the Messenger of Allah?" (7:75)

The Muslims used to reply:

"Indeed, we believe in the Message brought by him."

Then the rejectors used to say:

"Indeed for our part, We reject what you believe in." (7:76)

The arrogant and rebellious people of Nabi Saulih ﷺ refused to accept the call of their Nabi and requested a special sign from Allah's side. For this reason Nabi Saulih ﷺ prayed to Allah for a sign and he replied to them saying: The sign you required has come to you in the form of a she-camel. Note that if you are going to cause her any harm, it could lead to your destruction. Allah has appointed a fixed period for you and for the she-camel to make use of the water-to each his own time. One day for you and one day for the she-camel."

The Qur'ān has called it '*Naaqatullah*' Allah's she-camel. Actually all the creatures on earth are Allah's but because Thamood asked for a sign from Allah which came in the form of this she-camel, for this reason as a sign of its special honour it has been called '*Naaqatullah*' and by calling it '*Lakum Aaytun*' it was meant to convey the idea that it carries with it some special importance. However the people of Thamood were unable to tolerate its presence for very long among them and one day after planning some more they killed it. When Nabi Saulih عليه السلام came to know what they had done he was greatly saddened and exclaimed: "O Unfortunate people, In the end you were unable to bear her presence patiently. Now await Allah's punishment.' Within three days such a punishment will come that you will not be able to ward off, and this punishment will destroy you for ever."

The Punishment Over Thamood

The initial signs of the punishment started appearing from day break of the next day. The first day all their faces went yellow just as happens in the initial stages of intense fear. The morning of the next day their faces turned red as if that was the second stage of fear. The next day their faces appeared blackened and darkness were strewn across their faces. This was the third stage of fear, after which only death awaits.

After these three days the appointed time had arrived and at night a frightful noise was heard which destroyed the life of every one as they were. The Qur'ān refers to this noise as "*Sau'iqah*" (crashing thunder) and at another place called it "*Raa'jifah*" (which causes an earthquake), and somewhere else as "*Tau'qhiyah*" (freightful) and somewhere else a "*Sayhah*" (a shout).

At one place this punishment descended upon Thamood and at the same time destroyed its inhabitants and their habitation, dealing with the pride and arrogance of the evil-doers and at another place Nabi Saulih ﷺ and the believers were saved and protected.

Warning and Admonition

This has been the *Sunnat* of Allah. However from this *Sunnat* the Message of our Nabi Muhammad ﷺ has been excepted. This is so because Rasulullah ﷺ had declared: "I have prayed to Allah not to send such a punishment over my *Ummat* which will be general. And Allah has accepted this plea of mine." The Qur'ān confirms it thus:

"But Allah will not send on their a general penalty while you was among them." (5:33)

However, the Nation or people who demands a special sign from Allah on this condition that if that sign appears among them then they will believe, and afterwards still fail to believe, their destruction is a matter of certainty and Allah will not pardon them until such time that they repent and then accept Allah's deen. Otherwise the punishment will destroy them and they will become an example to others to come afterwards.

This is a great mistake to think that a man in wealthy circumstances, enjoying worldly grandeur and high rank is a person enjoying Allah's favours and that his wealthy position is necessarily a sign of Allah's pleasure.

QASASUL AMBIYAA

STORIES OF THE PROPHETS

Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy (Rah.)



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Qasasul Ambiyaa

(Stories of the Prophets)

By: Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy (Ra)

Translated by: Maulana Yusuf Karaan



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D-80, Abul Fazal Enclave-I, Jamia Nagar
New Delhi-110 025 (India)

Tel.: +91-11-2695 6832 & 085888 33786

Fax: +91-11-6617 3545 Email: sales@idara.co

Online Store: www.idarastore.com

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Shop 6, Nizamia Complex, Gali Gadrian, Hazrat Nizamuddin
New Delhi-110013 (India) Tel.: 085888 44786

Qasasul Ambiyaa

The Holy Qur'ān does not relate historical facts merely for the sake of telling a story which is of historical value. Its main aim in relating happenings is to draw attention to the results, conclusions and deductions from these incidents so that they become a source of guidance for men and prove to be lessons for them that appeal to their minds and emotions that from these historical events, lessons should be derived. These lessons should convince them that the existence of Allah is an undeniable fact and that His Mighty Hand is playing a major role in the affairs of men. It should also bring to their notice that to follow the stipulations of His deen brings success and leads to salvation and is the way towards all progress. That is what Islām—the natural religion—is about.

From: Qasasul Qur'ān

Preface

The most authentic and comprehensive work of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy, *Qasasul Qur'ān* needs no introduction. However, the Manner in which our friend Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version of a voluminous and bulky work he has undoubtedly, fulfilled one of the needs of this time. He has adopted such a method of abridgement whereby not only has he retained and mentioned every important fact in the lives of the Holy Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) and other saintly personalities, which are of lessons to men, but also discussed in brought outline some other important matters. It is hoped that with Allah's grace, those persons who are occupied and busy at all times, will be able to derive adequate benefit from this work.

The great effort of Sayed Tanzeem Hussain in this old age of his is really something praiseworthy. May Allah reward him well for this great effort.

Qari Sayed Rasheedul-Hasan Hussainy Nadwi

Imam and Khateeb

Jama Masjid, New Town

Allamah Binori Town, Karachi

P5 Muharram, 1308 Hijri

Publisher's Foreword

The respected personality of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy is one of the most eminent Ulama of the Indo-Pak Sub-Continent. His most approved and well-known book, *Qasasul-Qur'ān* is considered to be a unique publication on this subject. The point that distinguishes it from other similar books is the fact that after every story, Maulana has made use of deep thought and reflection to present to the readers the lessons and points of guidance from the related episodes. Thus for the teachers and lecturers at *Deeni Madressas* and for preachers in mosques and students of deen the study and perusal of this book is of utmost benefit.

The original book appeared in four volumes with over 1800 pages of subject matter. Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version there of in only 600 pages and this has been met with a verdict of approval from all academic circles, especially by virtue of the fact that he has fulfilled one of the most pressing needs of the time and by leaving aside unimportant discussions have given the busy and occupied ones also a chance to benefit from these work. May Allah reward him well.

Author's Foreword

All praise be to Allah who has guided us with the Holy Book and revealed to us the Qur'ān in a clear Arabic language and in it. He related the best of stories as an admonition and a reminder for the believers. And May peace and blessings be upon the Most truthful and trustworthy Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, the messenger of Allah and seal of all the Prophets and upon his offspring, and companions who were all of them guiding stars for all the righteous ones.

Among the inimitable ways in which Allah has chosen for the sake of the guidance of men, is this that attention is drawn to the good and bad deeds of nations and the resultant fruits of such deeds of which they are reminded so that those deeds may be a lesson for men. For this reason those stories are not being related in a style as is generally done in history. The major aim is to convey the truth and to invite to Allah and with this in mind attention is only drawn to those aspects which furthers this objective. For this reason there is constant repetition so that these events can sink into the hearts and minds of listeners and they become attentive towards them. This sinking in and attentiveness can only be achieved if the same event is repeated in various ways and styles whereby sleeping faculties are woken up.

The Qur'ānic stories and events deal mostly with previous nations and the Messengers of Allah (*Alaihimus*

Salām) who were sent to them and bit by bit other matters also become included there-in, mostly dealing with the arguments over good and bad and the battles between the friends of Allah and the friends of *Shaitan*, which in itself proves to be a great lesson and admonishment for me.

But, leaving others aside, there are today so few Muslims who derive benefit from Allah's last and perfect law-book, the Qur'ān, to fill our hearts with *Iman* and *Yaqeen*. After all it is Allah's law and we are commanded to implement its orders in our lives, Moreover we are required to ponder over its meanings as this Qur'ān is the means forwards acquiring success and salvation in both this world and the here after.

At the time of the Revelation of the Qur'ān, the Messenger of Allah became so distressed and defected at the enmity and opposition of the polytheists that he raised this complaint to Allah:

(5:25—30)

However, in this 15th century, if we should examine our hearts, we will find that in spite of our claims to be Muslims and believing the Qur'ān to be the word of Allah, how few are who have made this word of Allah the pattern for their lives and the model on which to base their lives, who read and recited with this aim in mind?

It was my aim, seeing this condition of my people and myself, to translate this great source of admonition into Urdu so that by presenting the translated version, the hearts of people will automatically become drawn to the original i.e., the Qur'ān and thereby acquire everlasting happiness.

In spite of my simple style of writing, care has been taken to confine myself to a few special points.

- (a) In this book the basis for all the stories is the Holy Qur'ān and the authentic *Hadith* and these have been further elucidated with historical facts.
- (b) Where there appears any contradiction or differences in the stories as told in the old testament and the Qur'ān, then with clear arguments an effort has been made either to reconcile the versions or with clear arguments to prove the truth as is expounded in the Qur'ān.
- (c) An effort has been made to point out the nonsensical Israili stories and where there have been nonsensical objections from enemies, these have in the light of the true facts been made clear for what they are.
- (d) In some special places there have been introduced some discussions on matters of disputes in *Tafseer* and *Hadith* and after discussing these the views of the saintly elders have been mentioned as a solution.
- (e) The facts concerning every Prophet ﷺ and in which chapter of the Qur'ān they are mentioned, has been gathered in one place.
- (f) Lastly, together with all the above points, a special heading of "Results and lessons", is introduced, giving the actual objective of this book and its main purpose viz., admonition and warning. Special attention is drawn to this aspect.

Servant of the Millat

Muhammad Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy

22 Rajab, 1360 Hijri

Translator's Foreword

For me as the translator of this book by Maulana Hifzur Rahman is a great honour. Throughout my student days in Darul Uloom Deoband in India, Maulana Hifzur Rahman or as we know him then as the *Mujahid-e-Millat* was one of the most respected leaders of the Muslim community. We used to flock to listen to his most interesting lectures. And as the general secretary of the *Jamiatul-Ulama*, and a M.P. he was also a great 'Alim (scholar) as can be gauged from this book *Qasasul Ambiya* (Tales of the Prophets) which entailed great research. I can remember whenever the students were confronted with any problem in the lives of any of the prophets, they always took refuge in Maulana's book for answers. I took upon it as a great honour in being in some small manner associated with Maulana's scholarship, even though this is an abridged version of the original book. But I must also state that I found great difficulty in translating this book because of the exceptionally high quality of the Urdu language used in the book.

I hope that the English translation of Maulana Hifzur Rahman's scholarly work will also be of great benefit to the English-speaking people. I just hope that I have been able to do justice to the original thoughts of the author.

Yusuf Karaan
Strand, South Africa